

Supplier Delay and Origin Escalation SOP

AfaqRoute Logistics Services Co. (ARLS) | Saudi Arabia Operations

Document ID	ARLS-ORG-SOP-005	Owner	Origin Operations Manager
Effective	01-Jul-2026	Next review	01-Jul-2027
Version	1.0	Classification	Internal

Purpose

To control supplier-origin delays before pickup and dispatch so the downstream transport plan and customer commitment are updated early.

Scope

Applies where ARLS coordinates pickup from suppliers, factories, warehouses or origin agents.

1. Trigger events

- Supplier advises cargo will not be ready by the agreed cutoff.
- Pickup vehicle arrives but cargo, documentation or release is incomplete.
- Required export or booking information is unavailable.
- Quantity or packaging differs from booking and prevents planned movement.

2. Escalation clock

Elapsed from missed ready time	Action
0-2 hours	Origin owner confirms cause, remaining work and realistic ready time.
2-6 hours	Revalidate pickup slot, transport cutoff and downstream ETA.
6-12 hours	Account Owner informed if delivery commitment may be affected.
>12 hours	Origin Operations Manager escalation and documented recovery plan.
Missed booked departure	Commercial impact and rebooking options reviewed.

3. Recovery options

- Later pickup on the same route where cutoff remains achievable.
- Rebook linehaul, flight or vessel with documented cost and ETA impact.
- Partial shipment only when customer and operational constraints permit.
- Expedited service requires approval under the account commercial authority matrix.

4. Root-cause coding

- Use supplier_delay only when evidence supports supplier/origin responsibility.
- Do not use supplier_delay for carrier capacity failures, customs issues or customer-requested postponement.
- Preserve supplier written confirmation or an internal call note.

Records and audit trail

All material actions, timestamps, approvals, customer notifications and supporting evidence must be recorded against the shipment or incident reference in the transport management system.

Control note

This internal document does not replace Saudi laws, customs instructions, carrier terms, customer contracts or directions issued by competent authorities.